

DESIREE HOWELL

Computer Science Student | Game Development Concentration | Gameplay & Front-End Programming
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Computer Science student at NC State in the Game Development concentration, with two years of professional software work at Infosys and a decade running a small business's web presence end to end. Builds in React and TypeScript on the web, and in Unity, C++, and UEFN on the game side. Seeking a Summer 2027 software engineering or gameplay programming internship.

EDUCATION

North Carolina State University, B.S. Computer Science

Expected May 2028

- Concentration in Game Development.
- Webmaster, Video Game Development Club: sole owner of the club's website: design, build, content, and semester-to-semester maintenance.
- Relevant coursework: Game Engine Architecture (C++), Game Design, Operating Systems, Data Structures.
- Prior coursework: Wake Technical Community College (CS transfer credit); Meredith College (CS major coursework).

UNC-Chapel Hill Coding Bootcamp, Full-Stack Web Development Certificate

- Built and deployed full-stack applications end to end: React front ends, Express and Node.js APIs, and MySQL and MongoDB data layers.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, C#, C++, Java, C, SQL, HTML/CSS

Game & Interactive: Unity, Unreal Editor for Fortnite (UEFN), custom C++ engine architecture, gameplay programming, level design

Web: React, Node.js, Express, MongoDB/Mongoose, MySQL, REST APIs, Socket.io, Tailwind, Vite

Tools: Git/GitHub, Firebase, Heroku, npm, VS Code, command line

EXPERIENCE

Technical Associate, Extended Learning Program | Infosys, Raleigh, NC

2021 – 2023

- Wrote and maintained web application code in JavaScript and Java on contract engagements, working to enterprise delivery standards and deadlines.
- Completed a two-year technical development program and earned internal certifications in Java and full-stack web development.
- Presented project work to managers and peer engineers on a recurring cadence, defending technical decisions in review.

Web Administrator | Angelhare Forest Tree Farm, Raleigh, NC

2013 – Present

- Sole developer and maintainer of the public website for a family business operating in the Triangle since 1986: design, build, content, and a decade of ongoing upkeep.
- Ship seasonal site updates and marketing content ahead of each peak season, supporting a repeat-customer base of 100+ annual visitors.

PROJECTS

Would You Still Love Me? (Unity, C#): Narrative relationship simulator built in Unity. Sole programmer on the project team: implemented every gameplay system and the branching dialogue logic. Published on itch.io.

Bee The Change (UEFN): Level designer on a game jam entry: blocked out, playtested, and iterated the level layout and pacing in UEFN. Winner, Best Use of UEFN Tools, UNCG Games for a Change Jam.

Custom Game Engine (C++): Team-built 2D engine for NC State's engine architecture course. Implemented the input handling system that maps raw device events to the actions gameplay code consumes.

Portfolio Site (React, TypeScript, Tailwind): Ground-up rebuild of a 2019 Create React App portfolio on a modern Vite toolchain, written by hand rather than migrated: client-side routing, responsive layout, and project data driven from JSON.

Cloverleaf (React, Express, MongoDB, Socket.io): Full-stack forum with real-time chat, built by a team of four. Designed the UI and implemented core features, including Socket.io messaging and Passport authentication.

HONORS & AWARDS

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- Best Use of UEFN Tools — UNCG Games for a Change Game Jam, 2026.
 - First Place, DiamondHacks Hackathon — Meredith College, team of four, 2014.